

OIS-003

Constitutional Lifecycle Specification

1. Purpose

This specification defines how constitutional objects come into existence, evolve, interact, and cease active participation.

Implementations SHALL preserve lifecycle semantics independently of implementation technology.

2. General Lifecycle

Every constitutional object SHALL follow a lifecycle.

The lifecycle MAY vary by object type.

The lifecycle SHALL remain observable.

Required Lifecycle States

NON_EXISTENT

↓

CREATED

↓

ACTIVE

↓

EVOLVING

↓

SUPERSEDED

↓

ARCHIVED

Deletion SHALL NOT be part of the constitutional lifecycle.

Deletion MAY exist only as an implementation concern.

3. Identity

Identity SHALL be assigned exactly once.

Identity SHALL NEVER change.

Implementations MAY migrate storage.

Implementations SHALL preserve identity.

4. Versioning

Objects SHALL evolve by version.

Objects SHALL NOT overwrite historical state.

Every version SHALL preserve:

Identifier

Timestamp

Author

Parent Version

Reason

Evidence

5. History

History SHALL be append-preserving.

Past states SHALL remain reconstructable.

Implementations MAY optimize storage.

Implementations SHALL preserve meaning.

6. Mutation

Constitutional mutation SHALL occur only through constitutional operations.

Runtime operations SHALL NOT modify constitutional truth.

7. Supersession

Objects MAY become superseded.

Superseded objects SHALL remain referenceable.

Historical references SHALL remain valid.

8. Archival

Archiving SHALL preserve:

Identity

History

Relationships

Evidence

Context

Archive SHALL NOT imply deletion.

9. Resurrection

Archived objects MAY return to active participation.

Identity SHALL remain unchanged.

History SHALL remain complete.

10. Failure Recovery

Implementations SHALL recover constitutional state after:

Power failure

Repository migration

Database replacement

Cloud migration

Builder replacement

AI replacement

User inactivity

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Constitutional Operations

Every Place SHALL support the following operations.

CreatePlace()

Creates a constitutional Place.

Returns:

Persistent Identity.

JoinPlace()

Registers a Participant.

Returns:

Participant Identity.

LeavePlace()

Participant leaves.

Place continues.

RecordContribution()

Adds a constitutional Contribution.

Contribution becomes immutable after publication.

OpenExperiment()

Creates an Experiment.

RecordEvidence()

Associates Evidence with one or more hypotheses.

ModifyDefault()

Changes runtime behavior.

Requires evidence.

Does not affect Constitution.

SynchronizeLibrary()

Synchronizes constitutional knowledge.

Implementation MAY use:

Git

HTTP

Files

Federation

Offline media

Synchronization protocol SHALL remain implementation-independent.

ExportPlace()

Produces portable representation.

Destination-independent.

ImportPlace()
Reconstructs Place.
Identity SHALL remain preserved.

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Portability Requirements

Constitutional Ownership
Every Place SHALL remain sovereign.
Implementation providers SHALL NOT own constitutional knowledge.

Migration
Every Place SHALL remain exportable.
Every Place SHALL remain importable.
Migration SHALL preserve:
Identity
History
Evidence
Relationships
Defaults

Offline Capability
Implementations SHOULD continue operating without network connectivity.
Synchronization MAY occur later.

Public Library
The Public Library SHALL NOT own Places.
The Public Library indexes knowledge.
Places own themselves.